

Essay Language

IELTS Writing Task 2 · Study Handout

لغة المقال: كتابة الآيلتس المهمة الثانية

Lessons 1 to 5: the words you need for advantages and disadvantages, problem and solution, and agree or disagree essays.

What is inside

60 key words and phrases with meanings, Arabic translations and IELTS examples.

Five model essays (one for each essay type), with the lesson words and linking words marked.

Band 5 to Band 6.5 upgrades, so you can see exactly what raises a sentence.

A quick check after every lesson, with all answers at the back.

A linking words bank and an Arabic glossary for revision before the exam.

Name: _____

Class: _____

Designed by: Nazila Motahari

How to use this handout

Each lesson in this handout matches one app in the Essay Language series. Study the app first, then use these pages to revise and to check your writing.

Lesson	Focus	Essay type in the model	Use it for
1	Reading the question and paraphrasing	Advantages / disadvantages	Planning the first five minutes
2	Giving and softening an opinion	Agree or disagree	Introductions and conclusions
3	Advantages and disadvantages	Advantages / disadvantages	Balanced body paragraphs
4	Causes, results and solutions	Causes and solutions	Problem and solution essays
5	Explaining and giving examples	Agree or disagree	Developing every idea

What Task 2 asks you to do

- Spend about **40 minutes** on Task 2. It is worth twice as many marks as Task 1.
- Write **at least 250 words**. Under 250 words loses marks automatically.
- Write **four paragraphs**: introduction, two body paragraphs, conclusion.
- Answer **all parts** of the question. If it asks for causes and solutions, you must give both.

The four-paragraph shape

Introduction — paraphrase the topic, then say what the essay will do or what you think.

Body 1 — one main idea: point, explanation, example.

Body 2 — the second main idea, or the other side of the argument.

Conclusion — repeat your main message in new words. Add no new ideas.

Lesson 1: Read the Question

اقرأ السؤال

Read the question correctly, spot the essay type and paraphrase the topic.

You will learn to

- recognise 12 key words that appear in Task 2 questions
- identify advantages/disadvantages, problem/solution and agree/disagree questions
- paraphrase the topic of a question using synonyms

Word list

Word	Meaning	Arabic	Example
issue (noun)	an important topic that people discuss or argue about	قضية / مسألة	Traffic congestion is a serious issue in many large cities.
view (noun)	what someone thinks about something	وجهة نظر	Some people hold the view that homework should be banned.
opinion (noun)	your personal idea or feeling about something	رأي	In my opinion , online courses suit students who work.
argue (verb)	to give reasons to show that something is true	يرى / يحتج بأن	Some experts argue that exams create too much stress.
claim (verb / noun)	to say that something is true, although it may not be	يدعي / ادعاء	Many companies claim that their products are healthy.
benefit (noun)	a good or helpful result	فائدة	One benefit of public transport is cleaner air.
drawback (noun)	a problem or disadvantage	عيب / سلبية	The main drawback of online shopping is that you cannot try products on.
cause (noun / verb)	the thing that makes something happen	سبب / يُسبب	Fast food is one cause of rising obesity.
solution (noun)	a way to deal with a problem	حل	Building more metro lines is one possible solution .
extent (noun)	how much something is true; used in 'To what extent...?'	مدى	To what extent do you agree with this statement?
outweigh (verb)	to be more important than something else	يفوق (في الأهمية)	In my view, the benefits of technology outweigh the drawbacks.
measure (noun)	an official action to deal with a problem	إجراء	The government should introduce new measures to reduce waste.

The three Task 2 question types

Instruction words	What you must write	Opinion needed?
Do the advantages outweigh the disadvantages?	Both sides, then say which side is stronger	Yes
Discuss the advantages and disadvantages.	Both sides, equally	Not required (a short one at the end is fine)
What are the causes / problems? What solutions do you suggest?	Causes or problems, then solutions that match them	No
To what extent do you agree or disagree?	Your position, with reasons	Yes

Remember

Underline the instruction words before you plan. They decide the shape of your whole essay.

Paraphrase the topic in your introduction: change the words, never the meaning.

Useful synonyms: people → individuals; children → young people; important → essential; the government → the authorities.

Upgrade it: Band 5 to Band 6.5

Band 5	Band 6.5
Many people believe that children should learn to cook at school. (copied from the question)	It is often argued that young people ought to be taught cooking skills in schools.
Traffic congestion is becoming a serious problem in many cities. (copied)	In a growing number of cities, heavy traffic has become a major issue.
The advantages are outweigh the disadvantages.	In my view, the advantages of this trend outweigh its disadvantages.

Model answer

Task 2 question

Many universities now offer courses completely online. Do the advantages of this outweigh the disadvantages?

This is an advantages/disadvantages question, but the word **outweigh** means you must also give your opinion. Notice how the writer states the opinion in the introduction and repeats it in the conclusion.

Introduction	Nowadays, a growing number of universities allow students to complete their entire degrees on the internet, without ever attending a class on campus. While this trend has some drawbacks , I believe that its benefits clearly outweigh them.
Body 1: advantages	<u>Firstly</u> , online study is extremely flexible. Students can watch lectures at any time, <u>so</u> they are able to work or look after their families while they study. <u>As a result</u> , they can gain a qualification and earn money at the same time. <u>In addition</u> , online courses are often cheaper <u>because</u> learners do not have to pay for transport or accommodation. <u>For example</u> , a student who lives far from the capital can join a top university without moving to another city. Many educators argue that this flexibility has opened higher education to people who could not study in the past.
Body 2: disadvantages	<u>However</u> , studying online also causes some problems. The main issue is that students may feel lonely, <u>because</u> they rarely meet their classmates or teachers face to face. <u>For instance</u> , they cannot simply chat with a friend after a lecture or ask a teacher a quick question in the corridor. <u>As a result</u> , some learners lose motivation and do not finish their courses. <u>Nevertheless</u> , universities can reduce this problem with simple measures , such as live video classes and online study groups. <u>Therefore</u> , this disadvantage is not as serious as it first seems.
Conclusion	<u>In conclusion</u> , <u>although</u> online courses can make students feel isolated, their flexibility and low cost make higher education available to many more people. In my opinion , the advantages of online learning outweigh its disadvantages, and I expect even more universities to offer degrees in this way in the future.

Bold green = words from this lesson. Orange dotted = linking words.

Linking words to reuse

although · **while** · **however** · **therefore** · **in addition**

Quick check

Word bank: issue · outweigh · drawback · measures

1. The main _____ of studying abroad is the high cost.
2. In my view, the benefits of exercise _____ the disadvantages.
3. Air pollution is a serious _____ in many large cities.
4. The government introduced new _____ to reduce plastic waste.
5. Which type of essay is this? 'What problems does this cause, and what can be done about them?'

Answers are on the last pages.

Now write

Question: 'Some people think that all students should wear school uniforms. To what extent do you agree or disagree?' Write 2–3 sentences: (1) say what type of question it is, (2) paraphrase the topic in your own words, and (3) give your opinion.

Model answer for this task

This is an agree or disagree question, because it asks me to what **extent** I agree. The **issue** is whether young people ought to be required to wear the same clothes at school. **Although** some people **argue** that uniforms limit freedom, in my **opinion** their **benefits** clearly **outweigh** their **drawbacks**.

Check your writing: I named the question type · I did not copy the question word for word
· I gave a clear opinion · I used at least 3 lesson words

Lesson 2: Where Do You Stand?

ما هو موقفك؟

Give a clear position and support it politely and accurately.

You will learn to

- use 12 words and phrases to give a clear opinion
- show whether you agree completely, partly or not at all
- soften claims with words like tend to, many and often

Word list

Word	Meaning	Arabic	Example
I strongly believe that (phrase)	shows a very clear, strong opinion	أعتقد بشدة أن	I strongly believe that university education should be free.
In my view, (phrase)	a formal way to say 'I think'	من وجهة نظري	In my view, sport should be compulsory at school.
I completely agree (phrase)	you agree 100%	أتفق تمامًا	I completely agree that smoking should be banned in public places.
I partly agree (phrase)	you agree with some of the idea, but not all of it	أتفق جزئيًا	I partly agree with this statement, but there are some exceptions.
I totally disagree (phrase)	you do not agree at all	أعارض تمامًا	I totally disagree with the idea that teachers are no longer needed.
It could be argued that (phrase)	introduces an idea that some people have	يمكن القول إن	It could be argued that technology makes people lazy.
While it is true that (phrase)	accepts one point before you give your own view	رغم أنه صحيح أن	While it is true that exams are stressful, they motivate students to study.
support (verb)	to agree with and encourage an idea	يؤيد / يدعم	Many parents support the idea of shorter school days.
oppose (verb)	to disagree with an idea or plan	يعارض	Some drivers oppose the new speed limits.
tend to (verb phrase)	usually happens, but not always	يميل إلى	Young people tend to spend more time online than older adults.
convinced (adjective)	completely sure that something is true	مقتنع	I am convinced that reading improves vocabulary.
statement (noun)	a sentence that gives an idea or opinion	عبارة / مقولة	I agree with this statement for two main reasons.

How strong is your opinion?

Your position	Phrases you can use	Example
Agree completely	I completely agree · I strongly believe that · I am convinced that	I completely agree that internships should be compulsory.
Agree partly	I partly agree · I agree to some extent · While it is true that...	I partly agree with this statement, but there are exceptions.
Disagree completely	I totally disagree · I strongly oppose · In my view, this is wrong	I totally disagree with the idea that teachers are no longer needed.

Remember

State your position in the introduction and repeat it in the conclusion.

Soften claims that are too strong: all → many; always → often; is → tends to be.

Show the other side, then answer it: 'It could be argued that..., however, in my view...'

Upgrade it: Band 5 to Band 6.5

Band 5	Band 6.5
I think it is good.	In my view, this policy would benefit both students and teachers.
Everyone hates exams.	Many students tend to find exams stressful.
Homework is bad but also good.	While it is true that homework takes time, I believe it helps students remember what they learn.

Model answer

Task 2 question

Some people think that all university students should do an internship before they graduate. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

This is an agree/disagree question. The writer agrees completely, so both body paragraphs support that view. Notice how the writer mentions another view and then answers it.

Introduction	Some people believe that university students should concentrate only on their studies, while others argue that every student ought to complete a period of work experience before graduating. I completely agree with the second statement , because internships prepare young people for their careers and help them choose the right job. This essay will discuss both views and give the reasons for my opinion.
Body 1: the reasons people agree	Firstly , an internship teaches skills that students cannot easily learn in a classroom. For example , a business student who works in a bank learns how to communicate with customers, manage time and work in a team. Secondly , work experience helps young people make better decisions about their future: some discover that they love their chosen field, while others realise that it is not right for them. Therefore , students who have done an internship tend to feel more confident when they start their first job.
Body 2: the reasons people disagree	On the other hand , some students and lecturers oppose compulsory internships. It could be argued that several months in a company take valuable time away from studying, particularly in the final year of a degree. Furthermore , critics claim that a few employers use students as cheap labour instead of training them properly. While it is true that a badly organised internship teaches very little, universities can solve this problem by checking the companies and setting clear learning goals.
Conclusion	In conclusion , although internships take time and must be planned carefully, I strongly believe that all university students should gain work experience before they graduate. Internships build practical skills and help young people choose careers that suit them, so universities should make them a compulsory part of every degree. The long-term rewards for students, universities and employers are, in my view , far greater than the few weeks of study time that are lost.

Bold green = words from this lesson. Orange dotted = linking words.

Linking words to reuse

firstly · **secondly** · **for example** · **on the other hand** · **because** · **therefore**

Quick check

Word bank: tend to · While it is true that · oppose · convinced

1. Teenagers _____ use social media more than their parents do.
2. _____ exams are stressful, they prepare students for pressure at work.
3. Many residents _____ the plan for a new airport because of the noise.
4. I am _____ that reading every day improves writing.
5. Make this softer: 'All students hate homework.'

Answers are on the last pages.

Now write

Question: 'Students should be allowed to use their phones in class. To what extent do you agree or disagree?' Write TWO short paragraphs. Paragraph 1: the reasons people agree. Paragraph 2: the reasons people disagree, and then your own opinion. Leave an empty line between them.

Model answer for this task

Firstly, many people agree that phones help learning. Students can look up a new word in seconds or search for information during a task. **For example**, a learner who does not understand a question can find a simple explanation immediately, without waiting for the teacher.

On the other hand, some teachers **oppose** this idea. **It could be argued that** phones distract students, **because** messages and games interrupt their concentration. **While it is true that** this happens in many classes, clear rules can solve the problem. **Therefore, in my view**, phones should be allowed, but only for learning activities.

Check your writing: Paragraph 1 gives only the reasons to agree · Paragraph 2 gives only the reasons to disagree · I changed sides with a linking phrase such as On the other hand · I gave my own opinion at the end

Lesson 3: Good Side, Bad Side

الجانب الإيجابي والجانب السلبي

Describe both sides of a trend and contrast them clearly.

You will learn to

- use 12 words and phrases for advantages and disadvantages
- contrast two ideas with however, on the other hand and whereas
- write a balanced paragraph about the benefits and drawbacks of a trend

Word list

Word	Meaning	Arabic	Example
advantage (noun)	a good point that helps you	ميزة	The main advantage of online shopping is convenience.
disadvantage (noun)	a bad point that causes difficulty	عيب	One disadvantage of living abroad is being far from family.
downside (noun)	the negative part of something that is mostly good	الجانب السلبي	The downside of fast delivery is the extra packaging.
beneficial (adjective)	having a good effect	مفيد	Regular exercise is beneficial for mental health.
harmful (adjective)	causing damage or injury	ضار	Spending too long on screens can be harmful to children's eyes.
have a positive impact on (phrase)	to change something in a good way	له أثر إيجابي على	Public parks have a positive impact on people's wellbeing.
have a negative effect on (phrase)	to change something in a bad way	له تأثير سلبي على	Noise can have a negative effect on students' concentration.
convenient (adjective)	easy to use and saves time	مريح / ملائم	Online banking is convenient because you can use it at any time.
affordable (adjective)	cheap enough for most people to buy	بسعر معقول	Public transport should be affordable for students.
save time and money (phrase)	to use less time and less money	يوفر الوقت والمال	Shopping online helps people save time and money .
risk (noun)	the possibility that something bad will happen	خطر / مخاطرة	There is a risk that personal data could be stolen.
on balance (phrase)	after thinking about both sides	بعد الموازنة / بشكل عام	On balance , the benefits of the scheme are greater than the costs.

Contrast linkers: where do they go?

Linker	Where it goes	Example
However,	Starts a new sentence, after a full stop	Cars are convenient. However, they cause pollution.
On the one hand ... On the other hand ...	Starts each body paragraph; always used as a pair	On the one hand, city life is convenient. On the other hand, it is expensive.
whereas / while	Joins two contrasting facts inside one sentence	Trains are fast, whereas buses are cheaper.
but	Joins two short clauses inside one sentence	It is affordable, but the quality is lower.

Remember

Give a reason for every advantage and disadvantage. A list of points with no reasons stays at Band 5.

'Discuss the advantages and disadvantages' means cover both sides equally.

Useful closing phrase: 'On balance, I believe that...'

Upgrade it: Band 5 to Band 6.5

Band 5	Band 6.5
Online shopping is good and bad.	Online shopping is convenient for busy people; however, it can have a negative effect on local shops.
Cars make pollution. This is bad.	Private cars can be harmful to the environment because they produce large amounts of pollution.
Public transport is cheap.	One major advantage of public transport is that it helps people save money.

Model answer

Task 2 question

More and more people are choosing to shop online rather than in traditional stores. Discuss the advantages and disadvantages of this trend.

This question says 'discuss', not 'do the advantages outweigh...?', so you do not have to give an opinion. You must cover both sides equally. A short 'on balance' at the end is acceptable.

Introduction	In recent years, a growing number of consumers have started buying goods on the internet instead of visiting shops. This trend has changed the way many people spend both their money and their free time. This essay will discuss the main advantages and disadvantages of this trend.
Body 1: advantages	<u>On the one hand</u> , online shopping is extremely convenient . Customers can order products at any time of day, and the goods are delivered to their door. <u>As a result</u> , people save time and money <u>because</u> they do not need to drive to a mall or pay for parking. <u>In addition</u> , prices online are often more affordable , <u>since</u> customers can compare several websites in a few minutes. <u>For instance</u> , a student who needs a new laptop can easily find the cheapest offer.
Body 2: disadvantages	<u>On the other hand</u> , this trend also has some downsides . <u>Firstly</u> , customers cannot see or touch products before they buy them, <u>so</u> there is a risk that the item will be different from the picture. <u>As a result</u> , customers often have to spend time returning goods. <u>Moreover</u> , the growth of online shopping can have a negative effect on small local shops, which may lose customers and close. <u>For example</u> , in many towns, family-run bookshops and clothing stores have already closed <u>because</u> they cannot compete with large websites. <u>Whereas</u> a visit to a mall is a social activity, shopping online is something people usually do alone.
Conclusion	<u>In conclusion</u> , shopping online is convenient and affordable , <u>but</u> it also brings risks for customers and for local businesses. On balance , I believe it is beneficial , as long as people continue to support the shops in their community.

Bold green = words from this lesson. Orange dotted = linking words.

Linking words to reuse

on the one hand · **on the other hand** · **however** · **whereas** · **in addition** · **for instance**

Quick check

Word bank: convenient · harmful · whereas · On balance

1. Online banking is _____ because you can use it at any time.
2. Too much screen time can be _____ to children's eyes.
3. Trains are fast, _____ buses are cheaper.
4. _____, I believe the advantages of tourism are greater than its disadvantages.
5. Write one sentence about working from home using 'On the one hand ... On the other hand ...'

Answers are on the last pages.

Now write

Question: 'Many young people now work part-time while they are at university. Discuss the advantages and disadvantages.' Write one paragraph about both sides. Use contrast linkers to move from one side to the other.

Model answer for this task

On the one hand, working part-time is **beneficial** for students, because they earn their own money and learn to manage their time. In addition, a job can **have a positive impact on** their confidence. On the other hand, there is a **risk** that students will feel tired and fall behind in their studies. Whereas some learners can balance both, others find that long working hours are **harmful** to their grades.

Check your writing: I wrote about both advantages and disadvantages · I used a contrast linker to move between them · I gave a reason for each point · I used at least 4 lesson words

Lesson 4: Why It Happens, How to Fix It

لماذا يحدث؟ وكيف نعالجه؟

Explain why a problem happens and suggest solutions that match the causes.

You will learn to

- use 12 words and phrases for causes, effects and solutions
- link a cause to its result with lead to, result in and due to
- suggest realistic solutions that match the causes

Word list

Word	Meaning	Arabic	Example
lead to (verb phrase)	to cause something to happen	يؤدي إلى	Heavy traffic can lead to stress and long delays.
result in (verb phrase)	to cause a particular result	ينتج عنه	A poor diet can result in serious health problems.
due to (preposition)	because of	بسبب	Many flights were cancelled due to bad weather.
factor (noun)	one of the things that causes a situation	عامل	Cost is an important factor when students choose a university.
consequence (noun)	a result of an action, often a bad one	عاقبة / نتيجة	Obesity is one consequence of an inactive lifestyle.
tackle (verb)	to try hard to deal with a difficult problem	يتصدى لـ / يعالج	Governments must tackle air pollution urgently.
address (verb)	to start dealing with a problem	يعالج (مشكلة)	Schools need to address the problem of bullying.
reduce (verb)	to make something smaller or less	يقلل	Car sharing can reduce the number of vehicles on the road.
introduce (verb)	to start using a new law, rule or system	يطبق / يستحدث	The city introduced a new bus lane last year.
invest in (verb phrase)	to spend money on something to make it better	يستثمر في	The government should invest in public transport.
raise awareness (verb phrase)	to help people understand a problem	يرفع الوعي	Campaigns can raise awareness of healthy eating.
encourage (verb)	to make someone more likely to do something	يشجع	Lower fares would encourage people to use buses.

Cause, result and solution patterns

Function	Pattern	Example
Give a cause	One (main / important) factor is + noun	One main factor is the rising number of cars.
Show a result	X leads to / results in Y	Heavy traffic leads to long delays.
Show a reason	due to + noun / because + clause	Flights were cancelled due to bad weather.
Suggest a solution	To tackle this problem, + who + should / could + verb	To tackle this problem, the government could invest in metro lines.

Remember

Every solution must answer one of your causes. Slow buses → faster buses, not more car parks.

Solution verbs: tackle · address · reduce · introduce · invest in · raise awareness of · encourage.

Be specific. 'The government must do something' scores nothing.

Upgrade it: Band 5 to Band 6.5

Band 5	Band 6.5
People are fat because fast food.	One major factor in rising obesity is the popularity of fast food, which is high in fat and sugar.
The government must do something.	The government should introduce stricter rules and invest in public awareness campaigns.
Traffic is bad and people are angry.	Heavy traffic in city centres often leads to air pollution and stressed drivers.

Model answer

Task 2 question

Traffic congestion is becoming a serious problem in many large cities. What are the main causes of this problem, and what solutions can you suggest?

This is a causes + solutions question. Body 1 explains the causes and Body 2 gives solutions. Notice that each solution matches one of the causes.

Introduction	In many large cities around the world, roads are becoming increasingly crowded, especially in the morning and evening. This essay will explain the main causes of this problem and suggest some practical ways to tackle it.
Body 1: causes	There are two main factors behind traffic congestion. Firstly , the number of private cars has grown rapidly, because more families can now afford them. Secondly , public transport in some cities is slow and unreliable. For example , a bus journey can sometimes take twice as long as the same trip by car. As a result , people prefer to drive, even for short trips. This leads to long queues at rush hour, when thousands of employees travel at the same time, and due to these delays, many employees arrive at work late and stressed.
Body 2: solutions	However , there are several ways to address this problem. One solution is to invest in fast, frequent metro and bus services, which would encourage people to leave their cars at home. In addition , companies could introduce flexible working hours or allow staff to work from home one or two days a week, so that fewer employees travel at the same time. Finally , the government could raise awareness of car sharing through advertising campaigns. These steps would reduce the number of vehicles on the road.
Conclusion	In conclusion , traffic congestion is mainly caused by the rising number of cars and poor public transport. Therefore , governments and employers must work together, because better transport and flexible working could result in quieter roads and cleaner air. Although these changes will take time and money, they are essential if cities want to remain pleasant places to live and work.

Bold green = words from this lesson. Orange dotted = linking words.

Linking words to reuse

because · **as a result** · **therefore** · **one solution is** · **in addition** · **so that**

Quick check

Word bank: leads to · factor · invest in · raise awareness

1. Heavy traffic often _____ stress and long delays.
2. Cost is the main _____ when families choose a school.
3. The city should _____ better cycle lanes.
4. Campaigns can _____ of the dangers of smoking.
5. Suggest a matching solution: 'Students do not read because school libraries close early.'

Answers are on the last pages.

Now write

Question: 'Many young people in cities do not get enough exercise. What are the causes, and what can be done to solve this problem?' Write one paragraph with one cause, its result, and a solution that matches the cause.

Model answer for this task

One important **factor** is the hot weather, **because** it makes outdoor sport difficult for much of the year. **As a result**, many teenagers stay indoors, which can **lead to** weight gain. **One solution is** for local councils to **invest in** indoor sports centres with low fees. **In addition**, schools could **introduce** daily PE lessons to **encourage** students to be more active.

Check your writing: I explained one cause clearly · I showed its result · My solution matches the cause · I used should or could for the solution

Lesson 5: Prove It

أثبت فكرتك

Support every idea with an explanation and a clear example.

You will learn to

- develop an idea with an explanation and an example
- use 12 support phrases and topic collocations naturally
- write a well-supported body paragraph

Word list

Word	Meaning	Arabic	Example
for example / for instance (phrase)	introduces an example, usually at the start of a sentence	على سبيل المثال	Many jobs need digital skills. For example , nurses use tablets to record patient data.
such as (phrase)	introduces examples inside a sentence	مثل	Outdoor sports such as football and cycling improve fitness.
this means that (phrase)	explains the result or meaning of an idea	هذا يعني أن	Online libraries are open all day. This means that students can study at any time.
in other words (phrase)	says the same idea again, more simply	بعبارة أخرى	The policy failed. In other words , it did not reduce traffic.
which leads to (phrase)	shows the next result of an idea	مما يؤدي إلى	Many teenagers sleep late, which leads to poor concentration in class.
higher education (noun phrase)	study at a university or college	التعليم العالي	Access to higher education has grown in many countries.
academic performance (noun phrase)	how well a student does in their studies	الأداء الأكاديمي	Getting enough sleep improves academic performance .
a sedentary lifestyle (noun phrase)	a way of living with very little physical activity	نمط حياة قليل الحركة	Office work can lead to a sedentary lifestyle .
mental health (noun phrase)	the health of your mind and feelings	الصحة النفسية	Talking to friends is good for your mental health .
digital skills (noun phrase)	the ability to use computers and the internet well	المهارات الرقمية	Employers expect graduates to have strong digital skills .
carbon emissions (noun phrase)	gases, mainly from burning fuel, that warm the planet	انبعاثات الكربون	Electric buses help to cut carbon emissions .

Word	Meaning	Arabic	Example
job opportunities (noun phrase)	chances to get a job	فرص العمل	New industries create job opportunities for young people.

How to build a body paragraph

Step	Language	Example
1 Point	Firstly, · Moreover, · One reason is that...	Firstly, online study improves digital skills.
2 Explanation	This means that... · In other words... · which leads to...	This means that students become confident with technology.
3 Example	For example, · For instance, · such as	For example, a student who makes presentations weekly finds office software easy.
4 Link back	Therefore, · As a result, · This is why...	Therefore, online learning prepares young people for work.

Remember

A good example is specific: a real place, person or situation. 'For example, it is good' proves nothing.

'such as' goes inside a sentence; 'For example,' usually starts a new one.

Topic collocations: higher education · academic performance · a sedentary lifestyle · mental health · digital skills · carbon emissions · job opportunities.

Upgrade it: Band 5 to Band 6.5

Band 5	Band 6.5
Exercise is good. It is very good for people.	Regular exercise is beneficial because it improves both physical and mental health. For example, a 30-minute walk can reduce stress.
Phones are bad for students.	Excessive phone use can harm students' academic performance, since notifications interrupt their concentration.
Public transport protects the environment.	If more people take the metro, there will be fewer cars, which leads to lower carbon emissions.

Model answer

Task 2 question

Some people believe that young people today spend too much time on their phones and not enough time doing physical activity. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

Look at how every point is supported. Body 1 follows point → explanation → example exactly. Also notice the topic collocations from health, education, technology and work.

Introduction	Some people claim that teenagers now spend most of their free time looking at screens instead of being active, while others argue that phones are a valuable part of modern life. I largely agree with the first view, because excessive phone use damages both physical and mental health , although phones do have some educational value. This essay will discuss both sides and explain my opinion.
Body 1: health	Firstly , spending too much time on phones encourages a sedentary lifestyle . Many young people spend four or five hours a day on social media. This means that they sit for long periods and rarely exercise, which leads to weight gain and poor fitness. For example , a student who uses a phone until midnight is less likely to wake up early for a morning run. Moreover , constant notifications can harm academic performance , since learners find it difficult to concentrate on their studies.
Body 2: the other side	However , phones are not completely negative. They help students develop digital skills such as searching for information and creating presentations, which can improve their job opportunities in the future. For example , many students now use their phones to practise English or watch video lessons from top universities. Nevertheless , these benefits only appear when phones are used for a limited time and for a clear purpose. In other words , the problem is not the phone itself, but the amount of time people spend on it.
Conclusion	In conclusion , I agree that many young people spend too long on their phones and that this reduces the time they spend on sport and exercise. Parents and schools should therefore encourage a healthier balance, for example by limiting screen time at home and offering more after-school sports clubs, so that young people can enjoy technology without damaging their health.

Bold green = words from this lesson. Orange dotted = linking words.

Linking words to reuse

firstly · **moreover** · **as a result** · **therefore** · **however**

Quick check

Word bank: such as · This means that · which leads to · digital skills

1. Sports _____ swimming and cycling improve fitness.
2. Online lessons are recorded. _____ students can watch them again.
3. Many teenagers sleep late, _____ poor concentration in class.
4. Employers look for graduates with strong _____.
5. Add an example sentence after: 'Technology helps students study.'

Answers are on the last pages.

Now write

Question: 'Some people think that all students should study online instead of at school.'
Write ONE body paragraph that supports one point. Follow the pattern: point → explanation → example.

Model answer for this task

Firstly, online study can improve students' **digital skills**. They learn to use tools **such as** video platforms, shared documents and online tests. **This means that** they become confident with technology, **which leads to** better **job opportunities** later. **For example**, a student who creates presentations online every week will find office software easy when she starts work. **Therefore**, online learning can prepare young people well for the modern workplace.

Check your writing: I started with a clear point · I explained the point · I gave a specific example · I used at least one topic collocation

Linking words bank

Use two or three linking words in every paragraph. Too many, or the wrong one, is worse than none.

Function	Linking words and phrases
Adding a point	In addition, · Moreover, · Furthermore, · Firstly, · Secondly, · Finally,
Contrasting	However, · On the other hand, · Nevertheless, · whereas · while · although
Giving a reason	because · since · due to · as
Showing a result	As a result, · Therefore, · Consequently, · which leads to · so that
Explaining	This means that... · In other words, · That is to say,
Giving examples	For example, · For instance, · such as · in particular
Giving your opinion	In my view, · I strongly believe that · In my opinion, · I am convinced that
Concluding	In conclusion, · To sum up, · Overall, · On balance,

Three common mistakes

However starts a new sentence: Cars are fast. However, they pollute. — not: Cars are fast however they pollute.

Because needs a clause, **due to** needs a noun: because it rained / due to the rain.

Such as goes inside a sentence; **For example**, usually starts one.

Arabic glossary

All 60 words and phrases from the five lessons.

Lesson 1: Read the Question

issue	قضية / مسألة	view	وجهة نظر
opinion	رأي	argue	يرى / يحتج بأن
claim	يدّعي / ادّعاء	benefit	فائدة
drawback	عيب / سلبية	cause	سبب / يُسبب
solution	حل	extent	مدى
outweigh	يفوق (في الأهمية)	measure	إجراء

Lesson 2: Where Do You Stand?

I strongly believe that	أعتقد بشدة أنّ	In my view,	من وجهة نظري
I completely agree	أُتفق تمامًا	I partly agree	أُتفق جزئيًا
I totally disagree	أعارض تمامًا	It could be argued that	يمكن القول إنّ
While it is true that	رغم أنّه صحيح أنّ	support	يؤيّد / يدعم
oppose	يعارض	tend to	يميل إلى
convinced	مقتنع	statement	عبارة / مقولة

Lesson 3: Good Side, Bad Side

advantage	ميزة	disadvantage	عيب
downside	الجانب السلبي	beneficial	مفيد
harmful	ضارّ	have a positive impact on	له أثر إيجابي على
have a negative effect on	له تأثير سلبي على	convenient	مريح / ملائم
affordable	بسعر معقول	save time and money	يوفّر الوقت والمال
risk	خطر / مخاطرة	on balance	بعد الموازنة / بشكل عام

Lesson 4: Why It Happens, How to Fix It

lead to	يؤدي إلى	result in	ينتج عنه
due to	بسبب	factor	عامل
consequence	عاقبة / نتيجة	tackle	يتصدّى لـ / يعالج
address	يعالج (مشكلة)	reduce	يقلّل
introduce	يطبّق / يستحدث	invest in	يستثمر في

raise awareness	يرفع الوعي	encourage	يشجّع
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Lesson 5: Prove It

for example / for instance	على سبيل المثال	such as	مثل
this means that	هذا يعني أنّ	in other words	بعبارة أخرى
which leads to	مما يؤدي إلى	higher education	التعليم العالي
academic performance	الأداء الأكاديمي	a sedentary lifestyle	نمط حياة قليل الحركة
mental health	الصحة النفسية	digital skills	المهارات الرقمية
carbon emissions	انبعاثات الكربون	job opportunities	فرص العمل

Quick check answers

Lesson 1: Read the Question

1	drawback
2	outweigh
3	issue
4	measures
5	A problem / solution essay (causes or problems first, then matching solutions)

Lesson 2: Where Do You Stand?

1	tend to
2	While it is true that
3	oppose
4	convinced
5	Many students tend to dislike homework. (many + tend to)

Lesson 3: Good Side, Bad Side

1	convenient
2	harmful
3	whereas
4	On balance
5	Model: On the one hand, working from home saves time. On the other hand, some employees feel lonely.

Lesson 4: Why It Happens, How to Fix It

1	leads to
2	factor
3	invest in
4	raise awareness
5	Model: Schools could keep their libraries open in the evening and introduce a reading hour after class.

Lesson 5: Prove It

1	such as
2	This means that

3	which leads to
4	digital skills
5	Model: For example, a student can watch a recorded lesson again before an exam.

Before the exam

Read the question twice and underline the instruction words.

Plan for five minutes: your position, two main ideas, one example for each.

Write four paragraphs and keep your position the same from start to finish.

Leave three minutes to check your linking words, your verbs and your spelling.